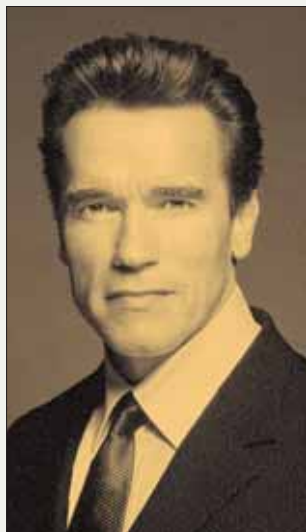


Tabloid TECH

People And Events That Grabbed The Headlines—For Better Or For Worse

The Career Girl



Celebrity blonde Paris Hilton is to serve a prison sentence for drunk driving, and she's been doing something about it. Like asking California governor A Schwarzenegger to pardon her. Herr Schwarzenegger doesn't seem to have done much about the situation, but the pretty Hilton has a lot going for her, and her sentence was reduced from 45 days to something like 23: she got credit for her "good behaviour."

Before that, the 26-year-old posted a blog on her homepage at MySpace, urging her 1,70,919 "friends" to sign a petition calling for her to be spared. Then, the poor girl's fans launched FreeParis.org in an attempt to collect a million signatures on a petition seeking clemency before she is to report to jail. "Please allow her to her return to her career and life," goes the petition. We know what her life consists in,



but we didn't know she has a career... but more on that later.

There are polls aplenty you'll find on the Web that go, "Should Paris Hilton be jailed?" And most often, the 90 per cent figure is in the red. The "Free Paris Hilton" petition gathered more than 25,000 signatures as of this writing; a rival campaign, "Jail Paris Hilton," has more than 60,000 supporters. So much for having 1,70,919 friends...

In the California "jail," which isn't quite like our jails, the girl will live in the "special needs housing unit." She will get at least an hour outside her cell each day "to shower, watch television, participate in outdoor recreation, or talk on the telephone." We're sure that'll be extended to, like, 16 hours or something—unless something like JailParisLike AProperPrisoner.org comes up.

Would you vote? Actually, do you care?

"Executive Summaries"

We're always on the lookout for delightful new Firefox extensions, and we found one that lets you search for celebrities. The Celebrity Search Firefox extension "puts all that Hollywood searching power right at your fingertips," as one blogger so accurately put it.

The developer put it this way: "You can search movie stars—actors, actresses and directors, musical performers, supermodels, politicians, prominent businessmen, other publicly known people. Nice research tool." You'll find the extension at <http://tinyurl.com/j2k2nvk>.

Research tool? What's to research on celebrities? So anyway, we selected "Pamela Anderson" off a site, right-clicked, and searched for the celebrity, hoping to research her... and *whump!* Mammaries! OK, we got distracted for a bit, then we looked at the "Executive Summary" for the person: it said "Star of Baywatch

and home movies." *Home movies?* That has that lingering something-fishy sound to it... did the folks at nndb.com (where the Firefox extension takes you to) intentionally imbue the humour into that one?

Next up was Paris Hilton—"Unexpected porno actress." Nuff said.

And then this writer typed in the name of someone we shall not name because we promised not to, and the Executive Summary went, "Oops... I did it again." The first paragraph of the person's profile goes thus (we've removed the person's name):

"Apparently the most successful of their numerous experiments, (she) was genetically engineered by the Disney Corporation to bring Western culture to its knees. OK, so that's a bit of an exaggeration: in fact, she was engineered to bring the enormous sex-deprived male population to its knees."

"Nice research tool." Hmm.

So This Is Web 2.0?

We've mentioned elsewhere in this issue that no-one really knows what Web 2.0 is, but here's news: some tech celebrities don't even care.

Truemors.com opened sometime in May. It's the brainchild of entrepreneurship expert Guy Kawasaki, who, when asked to describe it, had this to say: "It's true that it could have no purpose. I don't want to be known as a Web 2.0 company, but we're a Web 2.0 company."

Kawasaki has been a Silicon Valley celebrity since the 80s, when he was a Mac evangelist. Most famous quote: "Those who can, do; those who can't, motivate."

At Truemors.com, people can mail in or phone in "true rumours" they've heard. As of this writing, the top-rated Truemor was that British singer Amy Winehouse would be the new Bond girl. Ugh. Google her up.

